Annual Teaching Plan 2026

Grade 9 · Natural Sciences · South Africa · Senior Phase

School year: 2026 Terms: 4 Contact time: 3.5 hours a week

About this plan

This plan shows what is taught in each of the four school terms and the practical work or assessment that goes with it. Teachers follow the order of the topics. A topic may take more than one week. The weeks shown are the teaching weeks of the term, not the calendar weeks.

Strands

- Life and Living: cells, plants, ecosystems and the way people change the environment.
- Matter and Materials: atoms, elements, reactions, acids and bases.
- Energy and Change: electricity, heat and forces.
- Planet Earth and Beyond: rocks, weather and the solar system.

How to read the tables

Each term has one table. The first column gives the weeks, the second the topic, the third what learners do and learn, and the fourth the practical work or assessment task. Topics marked as belonging to another grade are shown for revision only and are not assessed in Grade 9.

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Term 1 · 10 weeks

Weeks	Topic	Content and concepts	Practical work or assessment
1 to 3	**Cells and their parts**	Plant and animal cells, the nucleus, cell membrane, cytoplasm and chloroplasts. Using a microscope. Why cells divide.	Make and draw a slide of onion skin. Labelled diagram test.
4 to 5	**Photosynthesis and respiration**	How green plants make food. How all living things release energy from food. Word equations for both.	Test a leaf for starch. Investigation report.
6	**States of matter and the particle model**	Solids, liquids and gases. Melting and boiling. This topic belongs to Grade 8 and is shown for revision only. It is not assessed in Grade 9.	No assessment.
7 to 8	**Atoms, elements and the periodic table**	Protons, neutrons and electrons. Reading the periodic table. Metals and non-metals.	Build atom models. Short test.
9 to 10	**Chemical reactions and word equations**	Signs of a reaction. Reactants and products. Conservation of mass. Writing word equations.	Term 1 test (50 marks).

Term 2 · 9 weeks

Weeks	Topic	Content and concepts	Practical work or assessment
1 to 2	**Acids, bases and the pH scale**	Properties of acids and bases. Indicators. The pH scale. Neutralisation in daily life.	Test household liquids with red cabbage indicator.
3 to 4	**Reproduction in flowering plants**	Parts of a flower. Pollination and fertilisation. Seeds and fruits. How seeds spread.	Dissect a flower and draw it. Practical report.
5 to 6	**Electric circuits**	Current, voltage and resistance. Circuit symbols. Measuring with an ammeter and a voltmeter.	Build a simple circuit and record readings.
7 to 9	**Series and parallel circuits**	Comparing the two kinds of circuit. Brightness of bulbs. Why homes use parallel wiring.	Mid-year examination (80 marks).

Term 3 · 10 weeks

Weeks	Topic	Content and concepts	Practical work or assessment
1 to 2	**Electric circuits**	Continued from Term 2: current, voltage and resistance. Practice problems and a second practical.	Circuit problems worksheet.
3 to 5	**Heat transfer**	Conduction, convection and radiation. Good and poor conductors. Insulation in buildings.	Compare how fast three spoons heat up. Investigation report.
6 to 8	**Rocks and the rock cycle**	Igneous, sedimentary and metamorphic rocks. Weathering and erosion. How rocks change over time.	Identify a rock collection. Practical test.
9 to 10	**Weather and climate**	Air pressure, wind and clouds. Reading a weather map. The difference between weather and climate.	Term 3 test (50 marks).

Term 4 · 8 weeks

Weeks	Topic	Content and concepts	Practical work or assessment
1 to 2	**Ecosystems and food webs**	Producers, consumers and decomposers. Food chains and food webs. How energy flows.	Draw a food web for a local habitat.
3 to 4	**Human impact on the environment**	Pollution, waste and loss of habitat. What a community can do about it.	Group project and class presentation.
5	**The solar system and the seasons**	The planets. Why the Earth has day and night and four seasons.	Make a model with a lamp and a ball.
6 to 8	**Forces and motion graphs**	Speed, distance and time. Reading distance-time graphs. Balanced and unbalanced forces.	Final examination (100 marks).

Assessment programme and notes

Term	Tasks	Marks
1	One practical report, one test	100
2	One practical report, mid-year examination	130
3	One investigation, one test	100
4	One project, final examination	150

Notes for teachers

- Electric circuits is taught over two terms: the start is in Term 2 and the practice is in Term 3.
- States of matter and the particle model is a Grade 8 topic. It appears once in Term 1 as revision.
- Safety: learners wear eye protection for all practical work with acids and heat.

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